ART ▼

ENTER THE VOID

A new exhibition at Delhi's **Gallery Dotwalk** featuring works on paper explores ideas of identity and history

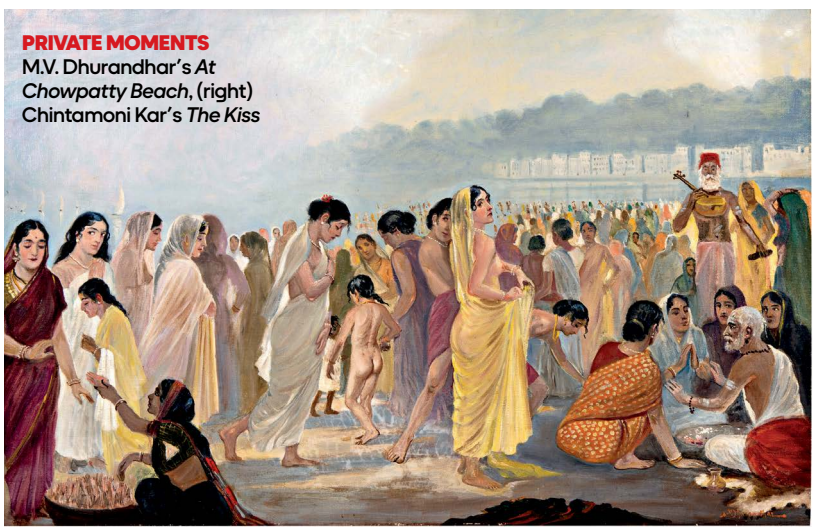


BEATEN INTO SHAPE Pieces like Somnath Hore's 'Blacksmith' explore the body's quiet resilience

When Gallery Dotwalk relocated to Defence Colony from Gurugram earlier this year, founder-director Sreejith N. found himself asking a simple question—how does one begin again, in a different room, without forgetting the histories that brought one here? The answer was found in their second exhibition, *The Architecture of the Void: Lines on a Postcolonial Skeleton*, which brings together an exceptional group of modern Indian artists, focusing on drawings, watercolours, etchings and works on paper, foregrounding a medium that was central to artistic experimentation in the decades following Independence and Partition.

Reflecting on the title of the exhibition, Sreejith says, "The works in the exhibition are built through lines—assertive, wounded, broken, mythical—that not just describe the form, but also actively construct space, memory and belonging. The void here talks about the uncertainty and the struggles that shaped the postcolonial moment. So, in a way, the title reflects the tension between the fragility and the memory, the surface and what is withheld," he says.

With its focus on paper, Sreejith believes that the exhibition invites the visitor to read paper itself as an active decision. "It prompts the audience to think about these questions: What does it mean for a newly decolonised nation to draw itself onto something that can crease, buckle, even tear? What kinds of worlds appear when we pay attention to the smallest mark, the faintest hesitation of the hand?" he says.



PRIVATE MOMENTS M.V. Dhurandhar's *At Chowpatty Beach*, (right) Chintamoni Kar's *The Kiss*

ART ▼

BACK TO AN ERA

An inter-gallery collaboration lets **art lovers into the post-Independence** work of India's most venerable artists

If there's one defining art show to take in right now, it's *Epochal: The Period of Pioneers*. This one-of-a-kind collaboration by DAG, Mumbai (at the Taj Mahal Palace), and Chatterjee & Lal affords the avid art aficionado a chance to see the work of several of India's greats until June 11.

Curator Mortimer Chatterjee, director, Chatterjee & Lal, explains